

2 Learning

Vocabulary 1: subjects at school

A Correct the spelling for the school subjects.

- | | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1. mathematics _____ | 2. history _____ | 3. geografly _____ |
| 4. siense _____ | 5. kemistry _____ | 6. fisics _____ |
| 7. biology _____ | 8. ekonomiks _____ | |

B Check that you understand the meaning of each subject. Tick the ones that you studied at school.

Speaking 1: looking back

A Match the pictures a–f with the sentences 1–6.



1. My favourite subject at school was Chemistry. ____
2. I really enjoyed sports at school. ____
3. I wasn't very good at Maths. ____
4. The teachers at school were very strict. ____
5. We had to wear a school uniform. ____
6. I had to do homework every night. ____

Pronunciation check

Listen to the pronunciation of these subjects. Practise saying the ending /iks/, as in 'Physics', 'Mathematics', 'Economics'.

B Talk with a partner. Use the pictures to talk about what you remember about school.

Grammar check

We use the *past simple* to talk about finished time. Regular verbs end in *-ed*, but there are some spelling rules that you need to remember.

Write the past form of these verbs into the sentences.

learn stop decide study

1. I _____ to swim when I was five years old.
2. I _____ Medicine at university.
3. I _____ to leave university and find a job.
4. I _____ learning guitar because I was too busy.

Remember to use *did* in negative and question forms.

I didn't like school much. *Where did you learn ...?*

There are a lot of irregular verbs, and some of them are used very frequently. You need to learn them.

Write the past form of these verbs.

1. know _____ 2. read _____ 3. think _____ 4. teach _____ 5. choose _____

There is no past form of *must*, so we use *had to*. *Had to* is followed by the base verb.

We had to wear a uniform to school.

Watch out!
typical errors

I don't liked school when I was little. **X**

How went you to school in the morning? **X**

I must did homework every night. **X**

Pronunciation check

 Listen to the pronunciation of the regular verbs in the sentences. Note the difference between /t/ and /d/ and /id/ at the end of verbs.

1. I finished my homework late last night.
2. I played football after school.
3. I hated Physics at school.

Speaking 2: answering questions about the past

A  Look at these questions about being at school. Then listen to some students answering them. Tick the speaker who gives a better answer.

- | | | |
|---|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. Did you enjoy being at school? | Speaker 1 _____ | Speaker 2 _____ |
| 2. What was your favourite subject at school? | Speaker 1 _____ | Speaker 2 _____ |
| 3. Who was your favourite teacher at school? | Speaker 1 _____ | Speaker 2 _____ |

B Walk around the classroom. Ask and answer questions 1–3 in Exercise A.

Vocabulary 2: likes and preferences

A Look at how the highlighted words and phrases are used in these sentences. Write (P) if the speaker is positive or (N) if the speaker is negative.

1. I **really liked** learning Mathematics at school. _____
2. I **didn't like** History **very much**. _____
3. I liked Physics, but I **preferred** Chemistry. _____
4. My **favourite** subject was Economics. _____
5. I **really hated** learning History. _____
6. I **loved** learning on computers. _____
7. I always **enjoyed** my English classes. _____
8. I **was** very **keen on** sports when I was at school. _____
9. I thought Geography was really **boring**. _____
10. The most **interesting** subject was Science. _____

B Talk with a partner. Talk about the subjects you studied at school using the words and phrases above. Say why you liked or didn't like some subjects.

Listening

2

Listening 1: listening for numbers and dates**A** Work with a partner. Practise saying these numbers.

16 60 100 160 166 600 606 616 660 666

B Listen and check. Then practise saying the numbers again.**C** Listen and write the numbers that you hear.

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____
 5. _____ 6. _____ 7. _____ 8. _____

D Listen and practise saying these bigger numbers.

1,000 10,000 100,000 1,100 1,500 1,550 1,555

E Unjumble the letters to write the twelve months of the year in the spaces.

yanurja	arybruef	amrhc	prail	yam	neuj
<u>January</u>	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
ujyl	austgu	bersetepm	oberoct	vemnoerb	mdeecerb
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

F Cover Exercise E and write the twelve months of the year in the spaces. Be careful with your spelling.

January _____

G Listen to the pronunciation of the months. Then practise saying them.**H** Write the ordinal numbers in the spaces below.

1. (1)_____ 2. (2)_____ 3. (3)_____ 4. (4)_____ 5. (5)_____

6. (6)_____ 7. (7)_____ 8. (8)_____ 9. (9)_____ 10. (10)_____

11. (12)_____ 12. (15)_____ 13. (20)_____ 14. (25)_____ 15. (30)_____

I Listen to the pronunciation of the ordinal numbers. Then practise saying them.**J** Listen to someone saying the date below in two different ways.

December 15

K Practise saying these dates in two ways.

January 10 March 20 April 25 September 30

L Listen and write the dates that you hear.

1. _____ 2. _____

3. _____ 4. _____

M Talk with a partner. Answer these questions with a date.

1. What date is your birthday?
2. What date is your mother's birthday?
3. What date is your father's birthday?
4. What date is Christmas Day?
5. What date is New Year's Eve?
6. What date is American Independence Day?



Listening 2: practise listening for numbers and dates



Question-type tip: You will need to listen for numbers and dates in various parts of the Listening Module. The information will always be in the same order as the questions.

A A man is telephoning his local college about a course. For questions 1 and 2, listen and choose the correct answer.

1. Graham wants to do a course in ...
 - a. Physics
 - b. Geography
 - c. Photography
 - d. Philosophy
2. Graham wants to know about ...
 - a. the beginner's course
 - b. the intermediate course
 - c. the advanced course

For questions 3–8, complete the man's notes. Write **no more than three words or a number** for each answer.

Course starts – (3) _____.
 There are (4) _____ lessons over thirteen weeks.
 Course finishes (5) _____.
 Course costs (6) £ _____ paid in advance. No refund.
 Between (7) _____ and 10 students in the class. (8) _____ people on last course.

For questions 9–12, complete the booking form that the receptionist fills in.

Name: (9) _____.
 Address: Flat (10) _____, (11) _____ Chelsea Court.
 Age: (12) _____.

B Check the key on page 266. How many questions did you answer correctly?

C Tick the sentences about the listening task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

1. I read the instructions carefully.
2. I read the questions and predicted the type of answer I needed to write.
3. I used capital letters when necessary.
4. I spelt all my answers correctly.
5. I know why I got some answers wrong.
6. I am pleased with how many questions I answered correctly.

Key vocabulary in context

Cross out any wrong words in these sentences.

1. My History **course / class / lesson** begins at 9.00 a.m.
2. The **course / class / lesson** lasts for 13 weeks.
3. It is a small **course / class / lesson**. There are only six students.

Reading

2

Reading 1: scanning

A These five extracts are from the same web page. Skim them quickly and say what they are all about.

In Britain, you have to be 17 before you can start learning to drive. You need a provisional driving licence, which costs £38. You can apply for the licence before your seventeenth birthday but must wait until you are 17 before you take any lessons. All learner drivers must display 'L' plates on the vehicle they are driving.

Some people learn to drive more quickly than others, but on average it takes about 40 hours of lessons and about 20 hours of further practice. Most people have one two-hour driving lesson per week, but it is possible to do a more intensive course. You should only take your test when you feel that you are ready.

It is best to learn with an approved driving instructor. You can practise driving with another qualified driver, but that driver must be over 21 and must have had a full driving licence for at least three years.

The main purpose of the practical driving test is to ensure that you can drive safely. The test lasts about 40 minutes and is designed to test a range of driving skills. More people fail the test than pass it.

More people fail their practical driving test than pass it, probably because not enough people are really prepared for the test when they take it. The most common fault during the driving test is not observing carefully before moving onto a main road from a smaller road.



B Talk with a partner and answer the questions.

1. Can you drive?
2. When did you get your licence?
3. How many driving lessons did you have?
4. Did you pass your test the first time you took it?



Exam tip: In the Reading Module, you will save a lot of time if you can find the answers to specific questions quickly without reading all of a text again.

C Scan the extracts and answer these questions as quickly as possible.

1. How long is the average driving lesson? _____
2. How old must you be before you can help somebody learn to drive? _____
3. How much does a provisional driving licence cost? _____
4. How long does the practical driving test last? _____
5. What must a learner driver have on his or her vehicle? _____



Question-type tip: In the Reading and Listening Modules, you sometimes need to write short answers to questions. The instructions will say how many words you can use.

D Scan again and decide if these statements are (T) true or (F) false.

1. You must be 17 before you can apply for a provisional driving licence. _____
2. You can help other people learn to drive as soon as you have your licence. _____
3. Most people pass their driving test the first time they take it. _____
4. A lot of people take their test before they are ready for it. _____

E Choose the correct definition below.

1. *Scanning* is reading a text quickly to get a general idea of what it's about.
2. *Scanning* is reading a text very carefully to understand every part of it.
3. *Scanning* is looking for specific information in a text.

Reading 2: practise scanning



Exam tip: In various parts of the Reading Module, you need to scan a text for specific information. You should practise scanning exercises and try to do them more quickly as your English improves.

A Read the web page about swimming lessons. Match each part of the page with a picture.

Swimming – safe and fun!

There is no special age at which children should learn to swim, but it is an advantage to learn early. Learning to swim can frighten small children, and getting a professional to do the teaching is usually the best option. However, parents can do a lot to make sure that learning to swim is safe and fun.

A Prepare well

- > Ask family and friends if they know a good teacher.
- > Find out if your local swimming pool has lessons.
- > Make sure that the teacher is qualified and ask to see a teaching certificate.

B Have the right clothes and equipment

- > Buy comfortable swimwear.
- > Buy goggles to keep water out of your child's eyes.
- > Buy a swim cap to keep long hair out of the way.
- > Buy plastic sandals so that your child does not walk in dirty water with bare feet.

C Safety comes first

- > Check how deep the water is before your child enters the pool.
- > Remember that armbands will not always keep your child above the water.
- > Stay with your child if he or she is in deep water.

Swimming is easier for some children than others, and your child needs support. Tell your child that he or she is doing well. Do not push your child to do anything before he or she is ready.



B Answer these questions about learning to swim using no more than three words.

1. Who is the best person to teach your child to swim?

2. Who can help you to find a good teacher?

3. What should you ask the teacher to show you?

4. What can keep water out of your child's eyes?

5. What should your child wear on his or her feet?

6. What do all children need from their parents?

C Check the key on page 266. How many questions did you answer correctly?



Exam tip: Sometimes you can answer a short answer question by taking a word from the text even if you don't know it. Be careful, though – it isn't usually so easy!

D Tick the sentences about the reading task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

1. I read the introduction and the title and looked at the pictures before I read the text.
2. I skimmed the text to complete task A.
3. I am pleased with how quickly I did task A.
4. I read more carefully to do task B.
5. I knew which part of the text to look at again to find each answer.
6. I knew what to write for each answer.
7. I was pleased with how many answers were correct for task B.

Key vocabulary in context

Look at these nouns from the text. Use them to complete the sentences below.

safety support professional advantage

1. If you play basketball, being tall is a big _____.
2. When children do something difficult, they need _____ from people around them.
3. A _____ is a person who does something for money.
4. Most parents worry about the _____ of their children.

Cover the text and match the adjectives 1–4 with the nouns a–d. Then check your answers in the text.

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------|
| 1. comfortable | a. hair |
| 2. deep / dirty | b. swimwear |
| 3. long | c. feet |
| 4. bare | d. water |



WB For focus on reading skills, go to Workbook page 8.

Writing 1: structuring a letter



Exam tip: In the first part of the Writing Module, you have to write a letter. It might be a letter to a friend or to somebody that you do not know. Sometimes you will need to ask for information or apply for a position. Often you will need to explain a situation and say what you want somebody to do.

A You are writing a letter to somebody explaining a problem that you have. Put these stages of the letter into the correct order.

- ___ Explain the situation and how it affects you (in what way it is good or bad for you).
- ___ Say what you want the other person to do.
- ___ State the purpose of your letter.

B Answer these questions with a partner.

1. How many sentences should you write to say why you are writing?
2. How long should the main part of your letter be?
3. How many sentences should you write to close your letter?

Writing 2: stating your purpose



Exam tip: Each paragraph of your letter must have a purpose (it must be clear why you have written it). The first paragraph should state the purpose of the whole letter (why you are writing the letter).

A Look back at Writing 2 in the Writing section in Unit 1. Look at how the purpose of the letter is stated in each of the opening lines.

B Look at the advertisement and the notes that a student has made on it. What is the advertisement for and why is the student unhappy?

Two-week and four-week intensive courses in business English



Small groups 16 students in class!

Highly qualified teachers 3 different teachers – and not very good!

Free Course Book and Workbook Got Course Book after 1 week – no workbook

Modern school in city centre Old building – 5km from centre!

C A student is writing to a language school about a business English course. Which opening line is best? What is wrong with the other three?

1. I am really angry with you because my business English course was so bad.
2. I am writing about a business English course I recently took at your school.
3. I am writing to tell you that my English has not improved at all because I learnt nothing on the course I did with you.
4. I want some money back from your school because I am not happy with the course I did at your school.

D Write the opening line for each of these situations.

1. You write to a tour operator to complain about a hotel that you stayed in.
_____.
2. You write to tell a friend that you cannot go to his wedding.
_____.
3. You write to a telephone company to say that your line is not working.
_____.

Writing 3: organizing the main part of a letter

A Here is the main part of the letter to the language school. Put the lines 1–4 into the correct place at the beginning of each section.

1. During my stay, there were three different teachers.
2. Your advertisement promises that the Course Book and Workbook are provided,
3. You claim that your school is modern and in a central location.
4. Your advertisement says that the business English classes are small.

I studied on an intensive two-week course, but I learnt very little.

_____ I expected to study in a group of between six and eight students, but I was in a large class of 16. It was difficult for the teacher to give time to everyone.

_____ Nobody explained why, and none of the teachers seemed to have experience in teaching business.

_____, but this was not true. I received my Course Book on the Monday of the second week so could only use it for a week. I never got the Workbook.

_____ In fact, the building is old and the classrooms are not suitable. The technology is out of date. The building is 5km from the city centre, and I needed to catch a bus to get there from where I was staying.

B Read the completed letter on page 266.

Writing 4: closing a letter

A Talk with a partner. What do you think the student wants the language school to do?

B Here is the final part of the letter to the language school. Delete five unnecessary words. Then check on page 266.

I hope you to understand why I am unhappy with the service your school was provided. In total I paid the 1,200 euros for the course and I would like that you to refund 50% of that. I am look forward to hearing from you.

C Look at the exam practice section on page 33 for the writing task.

Speaking

A Complete each of these questions with the correct question word.

- _____ was your favourite subject at school?
- _____ was your best friend at primary school?
- _____ did you get to school in the morning – did you walk or take a bus?
- _____ did you go to college instead of staying at school?
- Do you remember any school trips? _____ did you go?
- In some countries, children learn languages from an early age. _____ did you start learning English?

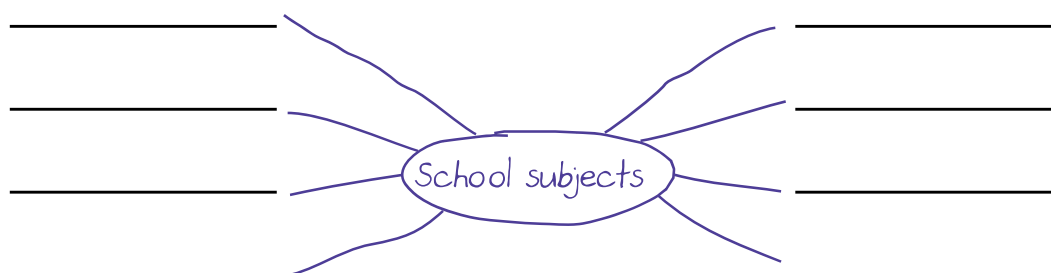
B  Listen and check.

C  Listen again and notice how the second speaker answers each question.

D Write five questions about being at school or learning something. Then walk around the class and practise asking and answering the questions.

Vocabulary

A Write eight school subjects on the diagram without looking back. Focus on your spelling.



B Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs below.

have fail pass apply do

- I _____ my homework before I went to bed.
- You can _____ for a driving licence before your seventeenth birthday, but you can't _____ lessons until you are seventeen.
- I _____ my driving the first time I took it. I was very pleased.
- Many people _____ their driving test because they are not ready to take it.

Watch out! typical errors

I made my homework. **X**
I made my driving test. **X**

C  Mark the main stress on these words. Then listen and check. Practise saying the words.

1. favourite 2. advantage 3. professional 4. safety 5. licence 6. certificate 7. support

Errors

A Correct the mistakes highlighted below.

- Did you **make** your homework last night?
- I didn't like school. I **must** do tests every week.
- My father **teached** me to swim.
- I didn't like **very much** Maths at school.
- I was very keen **in** Geography.
- I **missed** my driving test the first time I took it.

Exam Practice

2

Reading



Exam tip: In the Reading Module, there are three sections: social survival, training survival and general reading. Each section can have more than one passage, so there will be between four and six passages to read. There are 40 questions in total. You have one hour to read the passages and to write answers on a separate answer sheet. The passages gradually become more difficult. The text below is written at your level and there are 12 questions. You should try to complete the task in about 20 minutes.

A Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Are A Levels Just Too Easy?

Text A

Students all over Britain are getting very good A level* results. They should be happy and their parents should be proud. However, that is not so easy when everyone is telling you that the exam is too easy and that your results do not mean anything.

Text B

The number of passes has increased every year for 21 years, and now more than 20% of students are getting an A grade** in the exam. In the 1970s, only 10% got an A grade, while 20% failed the exam with an E grade. Now those percentages are reversed. Important people in education and business say that A level results have no value. They are worried that the exam does not show which students should be going to the top universities.

Text C

Other people say that the number of passes is increasing because students are improving and studying harder. They say that teaching has improved and that teachers know how to train students to pass the exam. Most students study five A level subjects but then only take the exam in the three subjects they are best at. Experts have studied exam questions and exam results, and they say that recent exams are not easier than the exams of twenty years ago.

Text D

It seems that the situation is like that in some sports events. Every year, a record is broken because athletes are becoming faster and stronger. In the long jump***, for example, the sandpit was made longer because athletes were jumping out the end of it. Some people in education believe that it is time to make questions in the A level exam more difficult so that questions really test the strongest students. This would provide better information to universities about who should get onto courses and better information to businesses about who should get the best jobs.

* A levels are advanced exams. Students stay on at school or go to college to study for A levels. Students take between two and five A levels, usually when they are 17 or 18 years old.

** An A grade is the highest grade you can get.

*** A sports event where athletes try to jump as far as possible.

Questions 1–7

The passage has four parts. In which part do you find the following information?

Write the letter in the space. Use some letters more than once.

1. Why people are worried about A levels becoming too easy. _____
2. What can be done about the problem. _____
3. How students should feel when they pass exams. _____
4. Some reasons why more students are getting better grades. _____
5. Numbers of students who pass or fail the exam. _____
6. Comparing exams with sport. _____
7. Both students and teachers are doing better. _____

Questions 8–12

Answer these questions using **no more than three words**.

8. What percentage of students got an A level A grade in 1970? _____
9. What percentage of students get an A level A grade now? _____
10. How many A level subjects do most students study? _____
11. How many A level exams do most students take? _____
12. Which sporting event are A level exams compared with? _____

Writing

A Talk with a partner. Decide if these sentences about the first part of the IELTS Writing Module are (T) true or (F) false.

1. The examiner will look at how your letter is organized. _____
2. You can use the same words and phrases in a formal and informal letter. _____
3. You need to write at least eight paragraphs. _____
4. You should start by saying why you are writing. _____
5. The examiner is not interested in the vocabulary that you use. _____
6. You should try to link ideas together into longer sentences if possible. _____
7. You can use as many words as you like in your letter. _____
8. It does not matter how you end your letter. _____

B You recently took six one-hour driving lessons at the Learn Fast Driving School. You are not happy for these reasons.

- You had three different instructors.
- The instructors were late and the lessons were under one hour.
- The instructors explained too much and didn't let you practise enough.
- The cars were older than you expected and not clean inside.

Write a letter to Learn Fast Driving School. Use at least 150 words.

Remember to ...

- state the purpose.
- explain the situation.
- say what you want the driving school to do.



Exam tip: Remember that you have 20 minutes, but you should spend some time thinking about what to include and then organizing your ideas. Leave about three minutes for checking for errors when you have finished.